



SMART BITES:

**7 Wholesome Recipes
in 35 Minutes (or Less!)**



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Smart Bites: 7 Wholesome Recipes in 35 Minutes (or Less!)



Healthy eating habits and [good nutrition](#) play a critical role in optimal health and wellbeing. But it can be challenging to find nutritious recipes that are not only delicious, but are also quick, easy to prepare, and budget friendly.

After the success of our first cookbook, [Healthy Recipes for Cancer Patients](#), NBCF is partnering with clinical registered dietitian Mickala Parsley, MS, RD, LD, with seven new recipes that taste great, fill you up, and can even help prevent several chronic health conditions and diseases, such as diabetes, obesity, and cancer.

Hand-selected for their approachability and ease to prepare, we hope these recipes satisfy your cravings for something yummy while supporting your overall health. These recipes are intended for anyone seeking to implement healthy eating habits and good nutrition in their lifestyle, regardless of a cancer diagnosis or not. Bon appétit!

Disclaimer: The recipes in the eBook should serve as a general guide for healthy meals. Please ask your doctor if there are certain foods that you need to avoid due to other medical conditions, allergies, or nutrient interactions with medications you may be taking before making these recipes.

About the Author



Mickala Parsley, MS, RD, LD

Mickala Parsley is a clinical registered dietitian who has a passion for oncology nutrition. She has worked in multiple cancer centers in the Indianapolis area.

Mickala attended Ball State University for her bachelor's and master's degrees in nutrition and dietetics. While she has been interested in food and nutrition for as long as she can remember, Mickala's interest in oncology nutrition began in college with her philanthropic work with Camp Kesem and her mother's diagnosis of stage 3 colorectal cancer. Mickala has seen firsthand how nutrition can play a pivotal role before, during, and after a cancer diagnosis.

Outside of her 9-5, Mickala runs social media channels and a nutrition blog, Sea Salt and Kale, where she enjoys sharing simple and digestible nutrition tips, recipes, and grocery suggestions. She also enjoys spending time outdoors and traveling with her husband, daughter, and two rescue dogs.

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Veggie Egg Bake

Break
fast



Serves 6 | Prep time: 5 minutes | Total time: 35 minutes

Eating breakfast can be difficult for busy adults. Eating a veggie-packed breakfast can be even harder. This Veggie Egg Bake is easy to make and can be prepped ahead of time for busy mornings.

The variety of colors within this dish reflects a variety of disease-fighting chemicals called phytochemicals which can help prevent chronic disease, including cancer. Try to include plants of all colors within your diet for optimal health.

Veggie Egg Bake

Ingredients:

1/2 onion, diced	Salt and pepper, to taste
2 bell peppers (any color), diced	Preferred seasonings, to taste, such as onion powder, garlic powder, red pepper flakes, and fresh thyme
Handful of greens (ex: spinach or baby kale), roughly chopped	Green onion, for garnish
12 eggs	
1/2 cup shredded cheddar cheese	

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 350°F.
2. Chop all vegetables and spread evenly in a greased 9x13" baking dish.
3. Crack eggs into a large bowl and whisk well. Add cheese to eggs and whisk well. Add pepper, salt, garlic, red pepper flakes, or whatever else you want to use and combine!
4. Pour egg mixture over veggies in the baking dish. Use the whisk to combine ingredients within the dish.
5. Bake for 30-35 minutes, or until egg is set. The USDA recommends egg mixtures be cooked to an internal temperature of 160°F.
6. Store egg bake in the fridge and simply pop individual slices in the microwave for a quick and easy, healthy breakfast. This would be great paired with fruit or a piece of toast.

Substitutions:

This recipe could be made dairy-free by using dairy-free cheese or by omitting the cheese.

Honey Blueberry Overnight Oats



Serves 1 | Prep time: 5 minutes | Total time: 5 minutes

These overnight oats are a healthy and simple breakfast that can be enjoyed at home or on the go. Did you know overnight oats are made without any cooking? Soaking the oats in milk and yogurt softens them enough to be eaten raw. This recipe is nutrient dense, containing protein, healthy fats, and fiber. A high fiber diet can help lower cholesterol, improve blood sugar levels, aid in weight management, and reduce the risk of chronic disease, including cancer.

Honey Blueberry Overnight Oats

Preparation tip: You can make several servings of overnight oats at once to keep in the fridge for grab-and-go on busy mornings! Make sure the extra servings are stored in air-tight containers. Keep in the refrigerator for up to 5 days.

Ingredients:

1/2 cup rolled oats (also called old fashioned oats)	1/2 tsp vanilla
1/4 cup plain Greek yogurt	1 tbsp chia seeds
1/2 cup milk	1/4 cup blueberries
	1/2 tbsp honey

Instructions:

1. Combine all ingredients into a jar and shake or stir to combine.
2. Place in the fridge for at least 2 hours or overnight.
3. Enjoy cold right out of the jar, or in a bowl with your favorite toppings, such as bananas, berries, nuts, seeds, nut butter, cinnamon, and more honey.

Substitutions:

These overnight oats can be made with other types of berries, bananas, or any other fruit you're craving! Just make sure to substitute the same volume of your selected fruit (1/4 cup) for the blueberries. This recipe could be made dairy-free by using dairy-free milk and dairy-free yogurt.

Seedtastic Energy Balls

Snack



Serves 6-7 | Prep time: 5 minutes | Total time: 10 minutes

These energy balls are great to prepare for grab-and-go snacks throughout the week that also satisfy a sweet tooth. Made with chia seeds and ground flaxseed, these energy balls supply you with a great dose of fiber, healthy fats, and even some cancer-fighting compounds called lignans. Lignans have been shown in studies^[1] to decrease growth and increase self-destruction of cancer cells.

^[1] [National Library of Medicine](#)

Seedtastic Energy Balls

Ingredients:

1 cup rolled oats (also called old fashioned oats; quick oats work too)	1/4 cup chia seeds
2/3 cup peanut butter	1/4 cup honey
1/4 cup ground flaxseed	1/2 cup dark chocolate chips

Instructions:

1. Combine all ingredients into a large bowl and stir well to incorporate.
2. Roll into one-inch balls.
3. Store in the fridge. Makes about 15 one-inch energy balls.

Substitutions:

Any nut butter can work in substitute of peanut butter. Sunflower seed butter is a great option for nut-free schools, workplaces, etc.

Egg Roll in a Bowl



Serves 4 | Prep time: 10 minutes | Total time: 15 minutes

Egg Roll in a Bowl makes for an easy, one-pan meal that happens to be delicious and nutritious. This recipe is essentially a deconstructed egg roll. It is full of flavor from the garlic, ginger, soy sauce, rice vinegar, and sesame oil.

Egg Roll in a Bowl

Cooking tip: Once you mince your garlic, let it rest for 10 minutes before adding it to the pan. Mincing, crushing, or chopping garlic starts an enzymatic reaction that creates allicin. Allicin is the precursor to chemical compounds that are known for their anti-cancer benefits. This is why garlic is considered an anti-cancer food. Avoid adding garlic to the pan too quickly, as this can halt this process, making garlic less protective for health.

Ingredients:

2 tbsp avocado oil	3 tsp rice vinegar
1 onion, diced	2 tbsp toasted sesame oil
1 lb ground turkey meat	1/2 cup chicken broth
5 cloves garlic, minced	1 16 oz bag of coleslaw
1 tbsp ground ginger	Sesame seeds, optional
3 tbsp low sodium soy sauce	Green onion, optional

Instructions:

1. In a large pan over medium heat, add oil and ground turkey, cooking until no longer pink. The USDA recommends ground turkey be cooked to an internal temperature of 165°F. Add onion and cook until onion is translucent. Add minced garlic and cook until fragrant, about 1 minute.
2. Add the remaining ingredients. Stir well.
3. Put the lid on the pan for 5-7 minutes to help the coleslaw become more tender. Stir frequently.
4. Serve warm. Garnish with sesame seeds and green onions.

Egg Roll in a Bowl

Substitutions:

This recipe can be made with any ground meat you prefer, such as beef, pork, chicken, or turkey. Ground turkey is recommended for this recipe because it is a leaner meat, making it good for heart health. However, any kind of ground meat can be used. The USDA recommends ground meats (beef, pork) be cooked to an internal temperature of 160°F and ground poultry (chicken, turkey) to 165°F.

Sheet Pan Teriyaki Salmon and Vegetables



Entrée

Serves 4-5 | Prep time: 10 minutes | Total time: 30 minutes

Sheet pan meals are convenient, and this one is no exception! Salmon is an excellent source of omega-3 fatty acids, which are healthy fats and great to include in your diet. Research has shown^[2] protective effects of omega-3 intake on chronic disease, including heart disease and cancer. It is recommended to eat fatty fish, such as salmon, twice a week for overall health. However, if you are not able to or prefer not to eat fish, there is a protein substitute listed at the end of this recipe.

^[2] [National Institutes of Health](#)

Sheet Pan Teriyaki Salmon and Vegetables

Ingredients:

4 salmon filets, approx. 6 oz each	1/2 tsp ground ginger
4 tbsp low sodium soy sauce	4 cups broccoli florets
2 tsp toasted sesame oil	3 cups sugar snap peas
2 tsp rice wine vinegar	3 tbsp avocado oil
2 tsp brown sugar	Salt and pepper, to taste
3 garlic cloves, minced	Green onions
	Sesame seeds
	Brown rice (optional)

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 400°F.
2. In a small bowl, whisk together soy sauce, sesame oil, vinegar, brown sugar, garlic, and ginger. Pour over salmon filets in a bowl or a large ziplock baggie. Let salmon marinate for at least 10 minutes.
3. While salmon is marinating, toss the vegetables with oil, salt, and pepper. Spread evenly on a parchment lined baking sheet. Bake for 10 minutes. Take the pan out of the oven and make a space in the middle of the pan for the salmon.
4. Add salmon to pan and bake all for an additional 15 minutes, or until salmon is cooked through. The USDA recommends salmon be cooked to an internal temperature of 145°F. Discard leftover marinade.
5. To serve, place salmon and veggies over a bed of brown rice (optional) and top with green onions and sesame seeds for a garnish. Brown rice is preferred over white rice because it is a whole grain. The Dietary Guidelines for Americans recommend making at least half of your grains whole grains.

Sheet Pan Teriyaki Salmon and Vegetables

Substitutions:

If you prefer to utilize chicken in this recipe, preheat the oven to 400°F and cut 4 medium size chicken breasts into 1-inch strips. Marinate in the same marinade as the salmon. Toss vegetables in oil, salt, and pepper. Arrange the chicken and veggies on the baking sheet, spreading them into an even layer. Bake all together for 20 to 25 minutes, or until the chicken is cooked through and the veggies are tender. The USDA recommends chicken be cooked to an internal temperature of 165°F. Serve over an optional bed of brown rice and top with green onions and sesame seeds.

Lentil Sloppy Joes

Entrée



Serves 4-5 | Prep time: 5 minutes | Total time: 35 minutes

Reducing meat in your diet can help improve your health and reduce your grocery bill. Plant-based proteins, such as lentils, are often cost-effective and provide additional fiber, vitamins, and minerals. Cooked lentils tend to have a similar texture to ground beef, making them an excellent substitution for meals like sloppy joes. A half cup of lentils contains 9 grams of protein and 8 grams of fiber. (The USDA's recommended daily amount of fiber for adults up to age 50 is 25 grams for women and 38 grams for men. Women older than 50 should have 21 daily grams of fiber and men 30 grams.) If you prefer a meat protein for this meal, see the substitution note at the end of this recipe.

Lentil Sloppy Joes

Ingredients:

1 tbsp avocado oil	1 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
2 garlic cloves, minced	1 tbsp brown sugar
1 small onion, diced	1 tsp paprika
1 cup green lentils, rinsed and sorted	1 tsp chili powder
1/2 tsp salt	Whole wheat buns
2 cups vegetable broth	Onion slices for garnish
2-4 oz tomato sauce (depends on how “saucy” you like your sloppy joes)	

Instructions:

1. In a pot over medium heat, sauté diced onion until translucent. Add garlic and cook for one minute until fragrant, then add vegetable broth, lentils, and salt.
2. Bring to a small boil, then reduce heat and simmer for 18-25 minutes, or until lentils are tender and broth is mostly absorbed.
3. Add remaining ingredients and stir well.
4. Serve on whole wheat buns with sliced onions.

Substitutions:

If you prefer meat as a protein source, sauté onion and garlic, then add 1 lb of your preferred ground meat, such as beef or turkey. Brown meat and drain off any excess grease. The USDA recommends cooking ground meats (beef, pork) to an internal temperature of 160°F and ground poultry (chicken, turkey) to 165°F. Reduce heat to low and add the tomato sauce, Worcestershire sauce, brown sugar, paprika, and chili powder. Stir well and serve once all ingredients are warmed through.

Greek Quinoa Salad

Entrée



Serves 4-5 | Prep time: 15 minutes | Total time: 25 minutes

This is a delicious and colorful salad that comes together in no time. Unlike most plant-based foods, quinoa is a complete protein, which means it contains all of the essential amino acids. Aside from protein, quinoa is also an excellent source of fiber, vitamins, minerals, and antioxidants. It is a great source of folate, which plays an important role in cell and DNA health, helpful in protecting against cancer.

Greek Quinoa Salad

Ingredients:

1 cup dry quinoa, cooked
according to packaging

1 cup feta cheese,
crumbled

3 mini cucumbers,
quartered

1 pint grape tomatoes,
halved

1 can chickpeas,
rinsed and drained

1/2 cup red onion, diced

3/4 cup Greek salad
dressing

Instructions:

1. Combine all ingredients and toss well. Serve chilled.

Substitutions:

While this is a vegetarian recipe, it could be made vegan by omitting the feta or using a plant-based cheese.